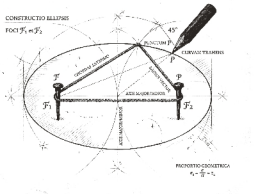
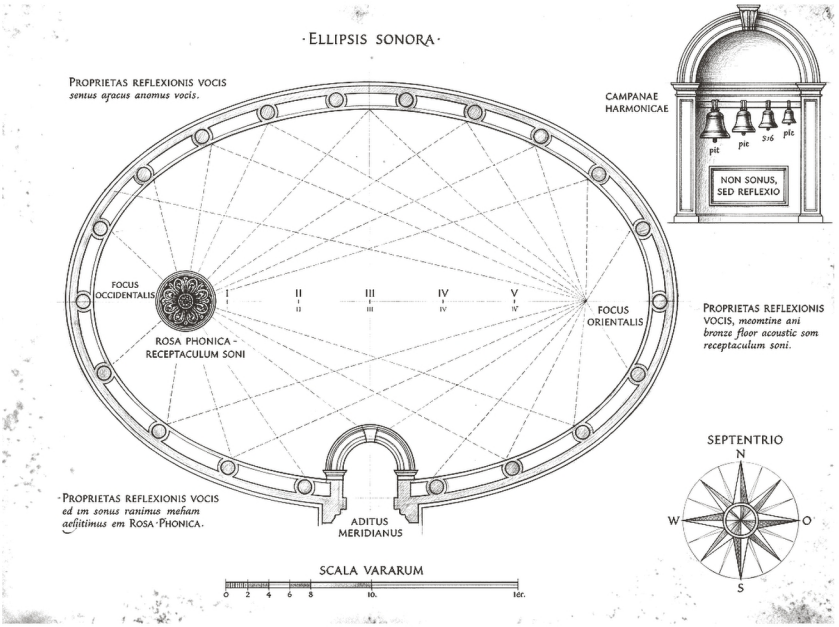
The Whispering Gallery

Beneath the narrow house, past the hearth where the raiders lit their fire, a stair leads to a silent hall with no corners. The Order laid it out using Kepler's planetary orbits: two pins in the stone, a string of ten varas, and a taut pencil. A whisper at one pin travels the curved wall to the other, clear as a bell. Nowhere else.



The pins are gone, but the string never stretched. Find where they stood along the floor: five varas measured from the northern curve to the central axis marks the listening rose. The raiders whisper at the eastern pin: stand at the western one, and listen.



The Secret of the Niche

The stone vault does not repeat a song: it mirrors it. When the five bronze bells of the niche ring across the stones, answer them not as they sounded, but from the last chime to the first.

« Non sonus, sed reflexio. »